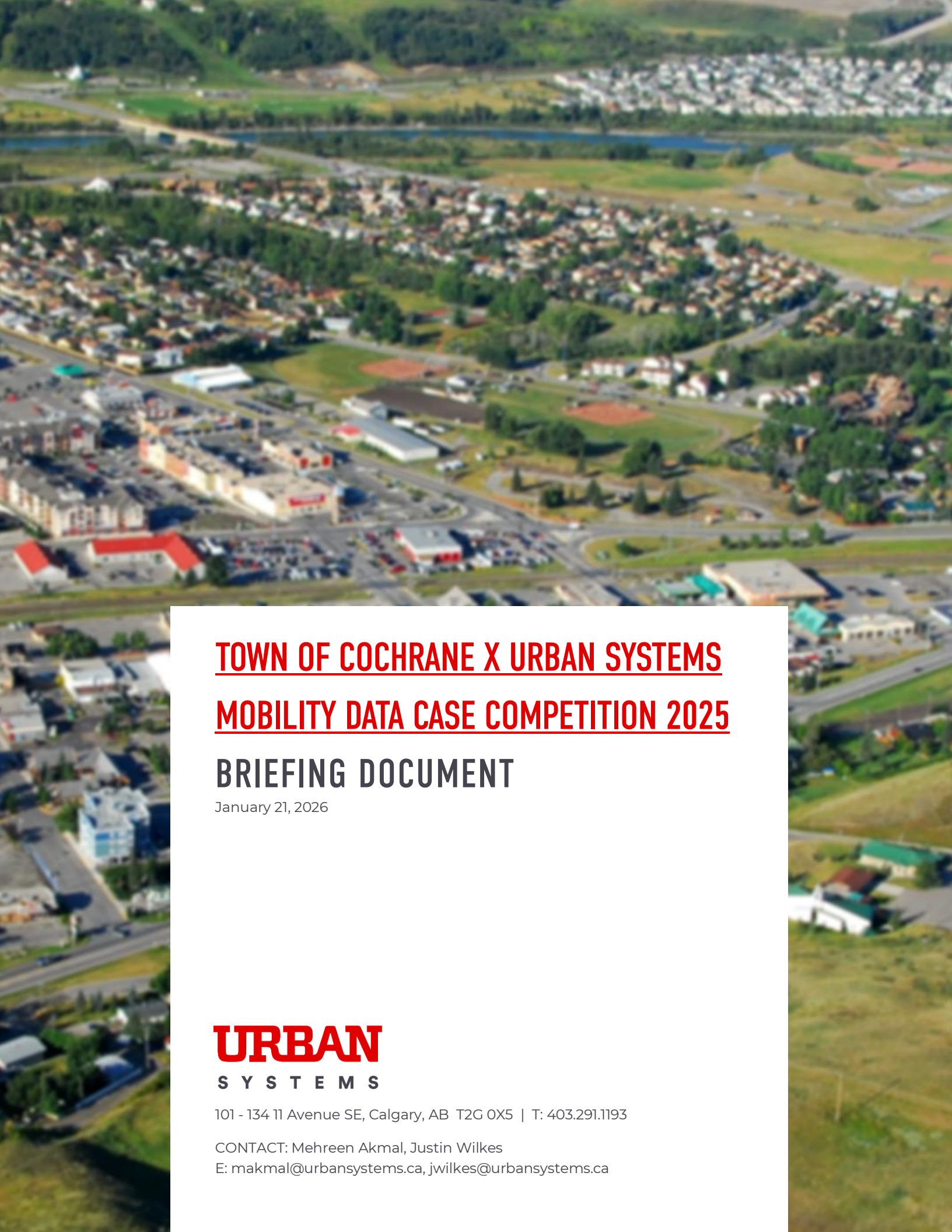




TOWN OF COCHRANE X URBAN SYSTEMS MOBILITY DATA CASE COMPETITION 2025

BRIEFING DOCUMENT

January 21, 2026

URBAN
SYSTEMS

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1.0 EVENT OVERVIEW

Urban Systems, founded in 1975, is a Canadian consulting firm committed to building vibrant communities. They work with diverse clients—including municipalities, Indigenous communities, and the private sector—on projects ranging from sustainable infrastructure development to addressing complex social issues. Their subsidiary, Urban Matters, focuses specifically on social innovation, using a community contribution model to reinvest profits into community initiatives. Urban Systems emphasizes collaborative relationships and interdisciplinary approaches to find effective, locally relevant solutions. Their services encompass various fields, including transportation, water systems, land use planning, and social program development. They strive to create safe, sustainable, and prosperous communities across Canada.

The Town of Cochrane, one of Alberta's fastest growing communities, is at a pivotal stage in shaping its future. With rapid population growth and increasing demands on transportation systems, there is a pressing need for innovative approaches to mobility planning and data-driven decision-making. This case competition invites students from GIS, Geomatics, Planning, and Data Science backgrounds to apply their skills in analyzing real-world mobility data to support Cochrane's vision for a connected, sustainable, and livable community.

Participants will work with a mobility dataset, including information ranging from traffic patterns to common daytime and nighttime locations, to identify opportunities and challenges facing Cochrane. The focus will be on developing actionable insights and strategies based on detailed analysis that balance growth with accessibility, sustainability, and quality of life for residents, while planning for future growth and economic development.

This competition emphasizes interdisciplinary collaboration, bringing together technical expertise, spatial analysis, and planning perspectives. Teams of 2-4 students will be challenged to design innovation, data-driven solutions that can help inform policy, infrastructure investments, and community planning.

Whether your strengths lie in GIS mapping, statistical modeling, urban planning, or storytelling through data visualizations, this is your opportunity to make a tangible contribution to the future of mobility in a real Canadian town.

Join us in Cochrane's journey – leveraging data, geospatial tools, and creative problem-solving to reimaging mobility and build smarter, more connected communities.

2.0 EVENT GUIDELINES

2.1 GENERAL CONDITIONS

By entering this competition, all participants acknowledge they have read and agree to these terms.

2.2 ELIGIBILITY

This case competition is open to University students currently enrolled in undergraduate or graduate programs. We welcome participants from diverse academic backgrounds, including but not limited to computer science, engineering, social sciences, business, design, communications, and planning.

Teams should consist of **2-4 members**, to ensure a balance of skills and perspectives. While individual participants can register and will be paired with others, we encourage pre-formed, **multi-disciplinary teams** to bring varied expertise to the challenge. A maximum of **96 entrants** will be considered.

No prior experience with geospatial data analysis is required—enthusiasm, creativity, and a willingness to collaborate are what matter most.

2.3 SCHEDULE

Thursday – January 22nd 2026

- **5:00 PM – Challenge Release**
 - Participants will receive an overview of the case theme, challenge details, and resources via email
- **5:00 PM – 6:00 PM: Virtual Kickoff Meeting (Optional)**
 - Welcome and introduction to the competition.
 - Overview of Urban Systems and the importance of GIS.
 - Explanation of the challenge and judging criteria.
 - Q&A session to address participant questions.
 - Team registration - opportunity for individual participants to form or join teams

Friday – January 23rd 2026

- **4:00pm – 5:00pm: Mentor Office Hours (Virtual)**

Monday – January 26th 2026

- **3:00pm – 4:00pm: Mentor Office Hours (Virtual)**

Wednesday – January 28th 2026

- **4:00pm – 5:00pm: Mentor Office Hours (Virtual)**

Thursday – January 29th 2026

- **11:59 PM – Submission Deadline**
 - All teams must submit their project (e.g. presentation slides, link to presentation video, and a brief description of their solution).

Tuesday – February 3rd 2026

- **6:00 PM – Finalists Selected**

- Top 5 finalist teams will be selected to deliver final in-person presentations.

Wednesday – February 4th 2026

- **5:00 PM – 5:30 PM Setup and Registration**
 - Presenting teams will arrive and prepare for presentations.
 - Food will be available for all attendees.
- **5:30 PM – 6:30 PM Final Presentations**
 - Teams will present (decided in a random order, to be posted at finalist selection)
 - Presentations must be delivered in person to be considered for prizes; not all participants need to be present.
- **6:30 PM – 7:00 PM Awards Ceremony**
 - Judges deliberate and announce the winners based on scoring criteria.
 - Awards and prizes distributed to winning teams
 - Closing remarks and recognition of all participants.
- **7:00 PM – 8:30 PM Open Networking**
 - Open Networking with Industry and students.

All participants are encouraged to attend the final presentations, to gain exposure to other projects, support fellow students, receive swag, and network/engage with industry sponsors.

2.4 RULES AND EXPECTATIONS

To ensure a fair, collaborative, and productive environment, all participants in the **Town of Cochrane Mobility Data Case Competition** are expected to adhere to the following rules and guidelines:

Code of Conduct

- Participants must maintain a respectful, inclusive, and collaborative environment.
- Harassment, discrimination, or inappropriate behavior of any kind will not be tolerated and may result in expulsion from the event.
- Participants should communicate professionally and constructively with teammates, mentors, and organizers.

Project Scope

- Projects must align with the competition theme of **Applying Mobility Data in the Town of Cochrane** and focus on enhancing accessibility, reducing barriers, or improving community engagement processes.
- Participants should come up with original work that does not infringe on rights of privacy or the intellectual property rights of others. Pre-existing projects, presentations or code are **not allowed**; all work must be created during the competition period.
- **We recommend equipping students with GIS tools, including ArcGIS, QGIS, and GeoPandas, to enable comprehensive geospatial analysis and unlock the data's full potential. However, students remain free to use any tools available to them.**

Use of Resources

- Participants may use any open-source libraries, tools, publicly available APIs, and datasets available online, provided they comply with licensing terms.
- Proper attribution must be given for any external resources or tools used in the project.
- AI tools and integration or use of external tools is supported and encouraged.

Development Timeline

- Work on projects may only begin after the official kickoff at **5:00 PM on Thursday, January 22nd**.
- Projects must be submitted in full by **11:59 PM on Thursday, January 29th**.
- No changes can be made to presentation slides after the project deadline.

Submission Requirements

- Each team must submit the following by the deadline
 - A short write-up or description of the solution, including its purpose, functionality, and impact.
 - A presentation (e.g. slides), that will be used for the in-person finals if selected.
 - A YouTube video link (or equivalent) to the group's recorded presentation.
- The submission must be made in the format specified by the organizers.
- Submissions received after the deadline will not be considered.

Mentorship and Support

- Mentors will be available throughout the event to provide guidance.
- Participants are encouraged to use these resources but must independently execute their projects.

General Expectations

- Participants are expected to actively engage with their team.
- Teams must ensure equitable workload distribution and collaboration.
- Organizers reserve the right to disqualify any team or participants violating these rules.

2.5 RESOURCES AND SUPPORT

To help participants succeed, we're providing access to expert mentors, to ensure teams have the guidance and information they need to develop innovative solutions.

Office Hours with Mentors

- Mentors will be available during the dedicated office hours on Friday evening from 4:00 – 5:00 PM, Monday afternoon from 3:00 – 4:00 PM and Wednesday evening from 4:00-5:00 PM. Additionally, mentors will be available for questions asynchronously throughout the competition timeline.
- Areas of Expertise
 - **Planning:** Knowledge of urban and regional planning principles, policy frameworks, and community development strategies.
 - **Land Economics:** Insights into market dynamics, feasibility analysis, and the economic impacts of land use and development.
 - **GIS & Spatial Analysis:** Proficiency in mapping, spatial data analysis, and geospatial modeling to support evidence-based decisions.
 - **Data Science:** Ability to analyze, interpret, and visualize complex datasets using statistical, computational, and machine learning methods.

How to Engage with Mentors

- **Drop-in Sessions:** Participants can join a virtual or in-person session to ask questions or discuss their projects.
- **Team Consultations:** Teams can request focused feedback on their specific solution or challenges.
- **Q&A:** Mentors will be able to clarify any doubts about the theme or judging criteria.

2.6 COMMUNICATION CHANNELS

Discord will be the primary communication platform for the competition, providing a centralized space for updates, collaboration, and support. The server will include the following key channels for:

Information

- **#new-competitors:** Landing page for new competitors.
- **#announcements:** Important updates, schedule changes, and reminders.
- **#resources:** Useful materials, guides, and references for participants.
- **#submissions:** Instructions and guidelines for submitting projects; deadlines and format.
- **#event-schedule:** Breakdown of event timeline
- **#rules-and-expectations:** Office rules, judging criteria, and participant expectations for the competitions.

Communication

- **#general:** Open discussion for participants to chat, ask questions, and share thoughts.
- **#mentor-support:** A space for participants to ask mentors for advice, clarification, and guidance on competition-related topics.
- **#technical-support:** Need help with coding, data, or troubleshooting? Post your questions here for mentor assistance.
- **#looking-for-team-members:** If you're searching for teammates, introduce yourself and connect with others here.
- **#off-topic:** A casual space for fun, non-competition-related conversations and networking.

2.7 JUDGING CRITERIA

Projects submitted will be evaluated by a panel of judges based on key aspects that reflect the case's goals. Judges will assess each solution for its creativity and overall impact, with a focus on how effectively it addresses challenges in public engagement.

The evaluation will emphasize each team's ability to clearly **define a mobility-related problem** or opportunity, conduct a rigorous **analysis of the provided dataset**, and **present actionable findings** supported by evidence. Judges will also assess the clarity, organization, and impact of the presentation, with **additional credit available for teams that enrich their work using external data** or innovative perspectives. Full details of the judging rubric, including the specific weight of each criterion, can be found in the Section 6.0.

2.8 PRIZES AND RECOGNITION

This case competition celebrates innovation and creativity by recognizing outstanding contributions to the challenges. Prizes will be awarded to the top three teams that excel in developing impactful and

creative solutions. While monetary prizes will only be awarded to the top three presenting teams, swag will be available during the in-person final presentations and networking sessions for all participants, in recognition of your hard work.

Prizes

1st Place – Best Overall Solution

- \$500 in Amazon Gift Cards
- Opportunity to present the solution to Urban Systems and Town of Cochrane leadership and stakeholders.

2nd Place – Runner Up

- \$300 in Amazon Gift Cards

3rd Place – Honorable Mention

- \$200 in Amazon Gift Cards

2.9 SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

To participate in the case competition, each team must submit by **11:59 PM on Thursday January 29th, 2025**. The submission will include a PowerPoint slide deck (or equivalent) that showcases the team's solution and supports their final presentation, as well as a short project summary to be submitted alongside the slide deck.

No changes to the slide deck can be made after the submission deadline, including for the final in-person presentations. However, feedback received through the judging process can be incorporated into the final presentations.

Submission Components

1. Project Summary

- a. A concise, one-paragraph overview that highlights the core of your submission. It should clearly articulate:
 - i. **The Problem:** Briefly describe the issue your project addresses, including its significance and impact on public engagement.
 - ii. **The Solution:** Summarize how your solution tackles the problem, highlighting its key features, innovations, and expected outcomes.
- b. This will be used to introduce your project before the presentation.

2. Slide Deck

- a. The slide deck must communicate your project effectively in a presentation lasting no longer than 10 minutes. The format is flexible, but your slides should include the following key elements:
 - i. **Team Slide**
 - Project Name
 - Team name (if applicable) and members
 - ii. **Problem Statement**
 - Clearly define the problem your project addresses
 - Include any relevant context, statistics, or user stories that emphasize its importance.
 - iii. **Solution Overview**
 - Present your solution in a clear and engaging way.

- Highlight its unique features and benefits.
- Explain how it addresses the identified problem.

iv. Supporting Visuals

- Include mock-ups, prototypes, flowcharts, or screenshots to demonstrate the design and functionality of your solution.
- Exported copy of all analysis completed on the recommended GIS platforms.
 - b. The submitted slide deck will be loaded and used for the final in-person sessions.

3. Presentation Video Link

- a. A virtual submission link must be uploaded that contains a <10 minute presentation of the group's solution, using the slide deck attached.

Presentation Guidelines

- Each team will deliver a **10-minute video presentation** and send a link of the uploaded video with their submission.
- The presentation must align with the submitted slide deck and highlight the problem statement, proposed solution, and key supporting visuals.
- If a team is selected to present in the finals, they must deliver the **10-minute presentation in-person** to a panel of judges, followed by **5 minutes for questions**.

Submission Process

- Submit the required materials in the specified format by **11:59 PM on Thursday, January 29th** to the designated upload platform or email address provided by the organizers.
- Late submissions will not be accepted.

2.10 OWNERSHIP OF THE WORK

Each participant shall retain ownership of any intellectual property rights it may have over the original work and materials submitted through this competition. By submitting an entry, each participant grants Urban Systems Ltd. a non-exclusive perpetual license to use, reproduce, publish, modify, incorporate into other work, distribute and promote, in whole or in part, the materials submitted by the participants for any non-commercial purposes. Urban Systems Ltd. respects the creative efforts of all participants and may contact teams or individuals after the event to explore potential collaborations.

2.11 PRIVACY

By entering this competition, participants agree to the collection of their personal information for the purpose of administering the Mobility Data Case Competition. All personal information collected by Urban Systems Ltd. will remain confidential and in accordance with applicable privacy legislation.

2.12 DATASET TERMS OF USE

The dataset provided for the Urban Systems Mobility Data Case Competition is strictly confidential and proprietary. By accessing this data, participants agree to the following terms:

- **Permitted Use:** The dataset shall be used exclusively for the purposes of this competition and may not be utilized for any other projects, research, or commercial applications without explicit written consent from Urban Systems.
- **Non-Distribution:** Participants are expressly prohibited from redistributing, sharing, or uploading the data to any third-party platforms, open-source repositories, online websites, cloud storage services, or any other public or private channels.
- **Data Security:** All participants must take reasonable precautions to secure the data and prevent unauthorized access or disclosure.
- **Deletion Requirement:** Upon conclusion of the competition, participants must permanently delete all copies of the dataset from their personal devices, cloud storage, and any other storage media.
- **Consequences of Breach:** Violation of these terms may result in immediate disqualification from the competition and potential legal action.
- **By participating in this competition, you acknowledge that you have read, understood, and agree to comply with these data usage terms.**

3.0 PROBLEM STATEMENT

Cochrane is growing fast, with travel patterns evolving across driving, walking, cycling, and transit. The community faces familiar small-city challenges: peak-hour congestion, network pinch points, limited multimodal connectivity, safety concerns, uneven access to key destinations, and the need to align transportation with land use and quality of life.

This case competition asks teams to use **mobility data** to identify and quantify a specific, evidence-based **mobility problem or opportunity** in Cochrane, then propose **actionable, realistic recommendations** for the Town. Your work should be grounded in analysis of the provided dataset and supported by relevant external evidence (e.g., municipal plans, open data, news, or demographics).

Illustrative challenges and opportunities may include (but are not limited to):

- **Congestion & Reliability:** recurring bottlenecks, peak spreading, travel-time variability.
- **Safety:** exposure-based risk patterns, conflict hotspots, safe routes to school.
- **Multimodal Gaps:** first/last-mile barriers, missing links for walking/cycling, transit access.
- **Accessibility & Equity:** differences in access to jobs, services, add parks across neighborhoods.
- **Land Use Interface:** mobility impacts of growth areas, parking pressure, curb space needs.
- **Seasonal/Weekend Peaks & Events:** demand surges and operational responses.

To address these issues, this case competition aims to explore the following question:

How can mobility data be used to identify and address Cochrane's most pressing challenges in ways that preserve our identity, strengthen connectivity, enhance livability, support a vibrant economy, and protect our open spaces and natural areas for the sustainable future?

3.1 YOUR MISSION

Using the provided **mobility dataset**, your team will:

- **1. Frame the Problem:** Define a clear mobility problem/opportunity for Cochrane, justified with data and supporting evidence.
- **2. Analyze & Diagnose:** Apply GIS/spatial methods and data science techniques to quantify conditions, trends, and constraints; be explicit about assumptions and limitations.
- **3. Recommend Actions:** Present prioritized, feasible recommendations (policy, design, operational, or programmatic) with expected impacts and trade-offs
- **4. (Optional) Geospatial Analysis Tools:** Geospatial data contains information about the longitude and latitude of specific locations or entities. To provide comprehensive results for the geospatial analysis, competitors are recommended to utilize one of the geospatial tools mentioned (ArcGIS, QGIS, GeoPandas, etc.).
- **5. (Bonus) Enrich the Data:** Strengthen your case by integrating additional relevant datasets (e.g., demographics, land use, schools, network characteristics, open street data).

3.2 FOCUS AREAS (FOR INSPIRATION)

While teams are free to innovate in any direction, here are three inspiring focus areas that may help steer your solution:

1. Land Economics & Downtown Revitalization

Objective: Explore how mobility and land use interact to shape economic development opportunities in Cochrane.

Key Questions:

- a. Which areas of downtown see the most/least activity today, and how might mobility improvements (walking, cycling, transit) support more businesses activity or intensification?
- b. If some industrial or low-intensity land uses were moved out of the core, what could replace them and how would this improve on some of the current challenges or opportunities observed?

2. Regional Connectivity & Tourism

Objective: Evaluate opportunities to connect Cochrane more directly to Calgary, Banff, and Canmore through transit and active transportation.

Key Questions:

- a. What could be the benefits of adding a Cochrane stop to a Calgary-Banff rail line?
- b. How might a special-event bus to Banff (e.g., for the Film Festival) change travel choices for Cochrane residents?
- c. What opportunities could a new pathway connection to Calgary or Canmore create for recreation and tourism?

3. Park Planning & Active Living

Objective: Consider how mobility data can inform access to parks, pathways, and recreational spaces.

Key Questions:

- a. Who currently has the best/worst access to parks and trails in Cochrane?
- b. Where are the “missing links” in the pathway network, and what difference would filling them make?
- c. How could improving access to recreation areas support both residents and visitors?

4. Transportation, Growth & Community Development

Objective: Identify how mobility diversity can support growth without relying solely on widening corridors.

Key Questions:

- a. How could Cochrane manage growth without just widening roads?
- b. How might more diverse mobility options (walking, cycling, transit, shuttles, etc.) reduce pressure on highways and improve local access?
- c. How can mobility planning make it easier to support a denser, more vibrant downtown?

3.3 CALL TO ACTION

Bring forward a **clear, evidence-based problem statement**, a **rigorous mobility analysis**, and **concise, actionable recommendations** that Town staff and decision makers can use. Community your insights with clear maps, metrics, and visuals understandable to non-technical audiences.

Teams may earn **bonus credit** by responsibly **enriching the dataset** with relevant external information to deepen the analysis or test scenarios. Your work should help Cochrane take practical next steps toward a safer, more connected, and more accessible mobility network.

4.0 DATASET DESCRIPTION AND DICTIONARY

4.1 DATA SET DESCRIPTION

We are well versed in analyzing and enriching human movement data (mobility data) utilizing Azira's Pinnacle platform datasets, for retail inventories, transportation or tourism studies, and park visitation projects. The mobility data sets are all based on tracking of mobile devices that use any one of 60+ applications. When applications are downloaded, users can agree (or not) to allow apps to track them constantly, when in use only, or not to track at all. Those who agree to allow continuous tracking will register more data points than individuals who use apps with increased privacy settings. It is important to note that no personal identification shows up in the data. Rather, each device is assigned a long and cryptic alpha-numeric ID

All data sets are provided as point locations. We typically choose to symbolize the clusters as heat maps to aid in interpretation and communication of point densities.

The typical datasets we acquire are:

- CDL/CEL Report – Common Daytime and Evening Locations for unique devices (global locations) that visited the geofence (study area) during a 1-year timeframe.
- Generator Report – also known as the Tourist Report, shows common daytime and evening locations for the 7 days prior to entering the geofence for devices away from their typical CDL or CEL locations.
- PIN Report – movements within the geofence during a 1-year timeframe.
- Pathing Report – includes the PIN report with the addition of observations up to 2 hours pre and post entering the geofence during a 1-year timeframe.

This data can be further extended by generating trade areas for various purposes, or enriched with Census and Environics variables to help understand the demographics behind the patterns and trends.

4.2 GEOGRAPHIC DATA LOCATION



The image above illustrates the geographic area covered by the dataset. A high-resolution version will be included in the competition package. Please refer to the folder contents for additional context and supporting materials.

While the data provided covers a specific area, teams are free to solve problems in any area of the Town.

4.3 AZIRA MOBILITY DATA OVERVIEW

4.3.1 PIN REPORT:

The Pin Report provides precise information about a device's location and the time it was present.

The dataset identifies which visitors were located within a specific polygon, the duration of their visit, and the exact latitude and longitude coordinates **In addition to these details**, the variables available in the pin report are:

- Polygon ID
- Azira ID
- Latitude of the Visitation
- Longitude of the Visitation
- Unix Timestamp of Visit.

Like all our reports that include timestamps, an option exists to convert the output of the report to contain the timestamp of point-in-polygon visits to be “friendly” dates, as well as a choice to convert to local time.

4.3.2 PATHING REPORT

The Pathing report provides information about where someone was before they arrived at a specific location. This report details the movements of a visitor leading up to and following their visit to a polygon, as well as the times they were observed at the observation point. The pathing report contains information about the travels of a device before and after being seen in a study location (the polygon of interest). To account for the timing of the visit from a different location relative to the original location, the timing of an observation is expressed in a +/- format. The '-' indicates the amount of time that has passed after a location visit, while the '+' indicates the amount of time prior to a location visit. The variables available in the Pathing Report are:

- Polygon ID
- UM ID
- Latitude of Point
- Longitude of Point
- Time Before Appearance in Polygon
- Unix Timestamp of Observation

A value of 60 in the 'Time Before' column indicates that the observation occurred 60 seconds before arriving at the study location. Additionally, a value of -120 signifies that the observation took place 2 minutes after the appearance at the study location. Note that some lines in this file will have a 'Time Before' value of zero, these are referred to as 'zero points' and represent observations made within the study location.

4.3.3 COMMON EVENING/DAYTIME LOCATIONS

This dataset provides information on the common evening and daytime locations of visitors within a specific area during a given time frame. For visitors observed within a particular polygon, the dataset identifies the locations where these visitors spend the majority of their time during the evening (Common Evening Location, CEL) and during the day (Common Daytime Location, CDL). These are high-confidence locations that are not available for all visitors.

- The expanded version of this dataset includes:
- Boundary information for over 175 countries and territories
- A summary file containing this data
- The distance traveled from the CEL/CDL to the study location

The **Visitors Home Report** combines information from the point-in-polygon report and the CEL reports into one convenient format:

- UM ID
- Polygon ID
- Timestamp Seen in Polygon
- CEL Latitude
- CEL Longitude

This report allows for the specification of a "Full Geo" output. When this option is selected, additional columns are appended to the report, right after the latitude and longitude values for both CEL and CDL. The appended columns include:

- Country
- State
- Postal Code
- Census
- Metro

4.3.4 DAILY VISIT COUNT

The daily visit count reveals the number of visitors in a specific location during a specific time frame. This dataset provides a day-by-day breakdown of the total count of visitors at a set location. The Variables available in the daily visit count are:

- Date
- Polygon ID
- Observed Devices

4.3.5 DWELL TIME

The dwell time represents an aggregated view of all locations included in the dataset. For this competition, the **only study polygon of interest is Cochrane**. The variables included in the dwell time dataset are:

- Study Polygon
- Total Visitors
- Measured Inner Visits
- Median Inner Dwell-Time (In seconds)
- Measured Outer Visits
- Median Outer Dwell-Time (In seconds)
- Avg Dwell-Time (In minutes)

4.3.6 LOCATION AFFINITY

The location affinity dataset reveals how visitors interact with different areas based on their movement patterns. This dataset provides a breakdown of visitor engagement across specific polygons, highlighting how frequently different target and control groups visit each location. The variables available in the location affinity dataset are:

- Polygon ID
- Brand
- Category
- Subcategory Visitor Type
- Type
- Region
- Target Group
- Visit Percentage
- Control Group
- Visit Percentage
- Target/Control Visit Ratio

5.0 SUPPORTING RESOURCES

The following is a non-exhaustive list of potential supporting resources to explore and include in your analysis or dataset enrichments.

5.1 RESOURCES

5.1.1 TOWN OF COCHRANE CENSUS DATA

The Town of Cochrane collects census data every five years, with the most recent census conducted in 2021. This data provides an insightful overview of the community's population, household characteristics, and individual demographic statistics.

Website Link: [Profile table, Census Profile, 2021 Census of Population - Cochrane, Town \(T\) \[Census subdivision\], Alberta](#)

5.1.2 TOWN OF COCHRANE GEOHUB

Cochrane's GeoHub is an open-data catalog that provides access to a wide range of geospatial datasets, including land use, property boundaries, parks, infrastructure, and historical aerial imagery. These spatial layers can be integrated into GIS analysis to better understand how Cochrane's built form, natural areas, and utilities interact across the community. For this competition, GeoHub data can help deepen the analysis and support stronger, evidence-based recommendations.

Website Link: [Cochrane GeoHub](#)

5.1.3 ENVISION COCHRANE 2050

Envision Cochrane 2050 is a comprehensive municipal development plan that will guide Cochrane's growth and development over the next 25 years. The municipal development plan serves as a decision-making tool that the Town of Cochrane will use to plan for the community's impacts on land use, the transportation system, and the environment.

Website Link: [Envision Cochrane 2050 | Let's Talk Cochrane](#)

5.1.4 ALBERTA OPEN DATA PORTAL

The Alberta Open Data Portal is a centralized collection of datasets from across the province, providing access to a wide range of statistics gathered from various municipalities. The portal includes data spanning economic, social, health, environmental, and other key domains, offering a valuable resource for province-wide and community-level analysis.

Website Link: [opendata - Open Government](#)

6.0 SCORING RUBRIC

CRITERIA	DESCRIPTION	SCORE
Problem Identification & Framing		/30
Clarity & Rationale	The problem or opportunity is clearly defined, relevant to Cochrane's mobility challenges or opportunities, and supported by evidence.	/10
Use of Supporting Evidence	Incorporates secondary sources (news articles, municipal plans, other datasets) to justify the problem/opportunity.	/10
Contextual Awareness	Demonstrates understanding of the community context (growth, mobility patterns, planning considerations).	/10
Analysis & Use of Mobility Data		/30
Methodology & Rigor	Applies appropriate analytical methods (GIS, statistics, visualization, modeling) with logical reasoning.	/10
Accuracy & Validity	Findings are technically sound, defensible, and transparent about assumptions or limitations.	/10
Effective Use of Provided Dataset	Leverages the mobility dataset meaningfully (not just descriptive maps, but actionable insights)	/10
Findings & Recommendations		/30
Actionability	Recommendations are practical, relevant to municipal decision-making, and demonstrate feasibility.	/10
Clarity of Insights	Key findings are communicated in a way that non-technical stakeholders (e.g., town planners, council) can understand.	/10
Impact	Solutions consider community benefits such as accessibility, sustainability, equity, or livability.	/10
Presentation & Communication		/10
Delivery & Engagement	Clear, confident, and professional presentation that is logically organized, engaging, and within time limits.	/5
Visual Communication	Effective use of maps, charts, and slides that support the message.	/5
Bonus (up to +5 points)		/5
Data Enrichment	Integration of external datasets, additional analysis, or innovative perspectives that strengthen the findings.	/5
Total		/100